

The Government Said PDD Was Exempt. Then It Wasn't.

A Documented Breach of the May 12, 2026 ADAP Placement Criteria

*Three PDD-eligible Albertans. One photographed placement letter.
AISH staff, on a live call: the published exemption “doesn’t exist.”*

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown

Supplementary submission to the documented record
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All figures sourced from Government of Alberta open data, primary-source public statements, and the campaign's evidentiary record.

Executive Summary

On May 12, 2026, the Government of Alberta released the final ADAP fact sheet. It named four categories of AISH recipients who would **automatically remain on AISH** rather than be transitioned to the new Alberta Disability Assistance Program. The first named category was Persons with Developmental Disabilities (PDD) eligibility. The fact sheet stated that approximately 30,000 Albertans would remain on AISH on this basis; approximately 50,000 would transition to ADAP.

Within fifteen days of that publication, three PDD-eligible Albertans have publicly documented being transitioned to ADAP — in direct breach of the government's own published criteria. One published a photograph of the placement letter itself. A second was told by the AISH office, when she called, that staff are receiving “a lot of calls about this” and “don’t know what’s going on.” A third documented a live telephone call — viewed roughly 1,700 times within 37 minutes — in which an AISH staff member denied that the published PDD exemption exists at all, while the recipient read it aloud from the government's own May 12 fact sheet.

The breach is not an isolated administrative error. It is the operational expression of a documented five-year pattern of removing public visibility from the PDD program. The Government of Alberta has not published PDD waitlist data since 2021. Inclusion Alberta formally requested this information; it has not been provided. Inclusion Alberta surveyed 540 PDD-connected individuals in late 2024 specifically because the government would not release the data. Caseworker assignments were eliminated in 2024–2025. The Citizens Appeal Panel was eliminated by Bill 12 in December 2025. The ADAP fact sheet was published in May 2026. The placement letters arrived the same week. The exemption criteria they were supposed to honour appear, on the documented record so far, not to have been honoured.

WHAT THIS DOCUMENT ESTABLISHES

Three PDD-eligible Albertans have been transitioned to ADAP under date of May 12, 2026, despite PDD being the first named category in the government's own published exemption list. AISH frontline staff have confirmed to a caller that the pattern is widespread, told another that they “don’t know what’s going on,” and — in a third, live-call case — denied that the published exemption exists at all. The placement criteria distinguishing the AISH and ADAP streams have not been publicly published. The PDD waitlist has not been publicly published since 2021. The breach is documented, operational, and ongoing.

1. The Published Criteria

1.1 What the May 12, 2026 ADAP Fact Sheet Says

The Government of Alberta's ADAP Fact Sheet, classified Public and issued by Assisted Living and Social Services under date of May 12, 2026, states that AISH will remain in operation for Albertans “with permanent and severe disabilities who are unable to work.” The fact sheet describes the AISH-to-ADAP transition as affecting approximately 50,000 recipients, and names four categories of recipients who will automatically remain on AISH:

#	Category	Basis
1.	Persons with Developmental Disabilities (PDD)	Eligibility-based
2.	Age 60 and over	Demographic
3.	Continuing care	Care-setting
4.	Palliative care	Medical-status

Source: Government of Alberta — ADAP Fact Sheet (Classification: Public), Assisted Living and Social Services, May 12, 2026.

1.2 What the Criteria Do Not Say

The fact sheet names the four exemption categories. It does not publish the operational criteria by which an individual recipient's file is assessed against those categories. As of the date of this submission, the Government of Alberta has not publicly released:

- the decision-making criteria used by AISH staff to assign individual recipients to either the AISH-continuing or ADAP-transitioning stream;
- the documentary evidence required to establish that a recipient falls within one of the four exempt categories;
- the appeal or correction mechanism available to a recipient who believes their placement letter is in error;
- the Ministerial Order operational employment-income clawback rates referenced in the May 12, 2026 fact sheet but not yet filed in the Alberta Gazette.

Shadow Minister Marie Renaud, in a floor statement on May 14, 2026, identified the unpublished placement criteria as the most consequential unanswered question for the approximately 80,000 Albertans affected by the AISH-to-ADAP transition. That question has not been answered.

2. The Documented Breach

Between May 26 and May 27, 2026 — fifteen days after the publication of the ADAP Fact Sheet, and approximately 36 days before the July 1, 2026 launch of ADAP — three PDD-eligible Albertans have publicly documented being transitioned to ADAP rather than continued on AISH. Two posted in the public Alberta Disability System Breakdown Facebook group; the third in a separate Alberta disability community group. All three are summarized below in the words they themselves used on the public record. Together they show an escalating pattern: a placement letter that breached the published criteria, an AISH office that could not explain it, and an AISH staff member who denied the criteria existed at all.

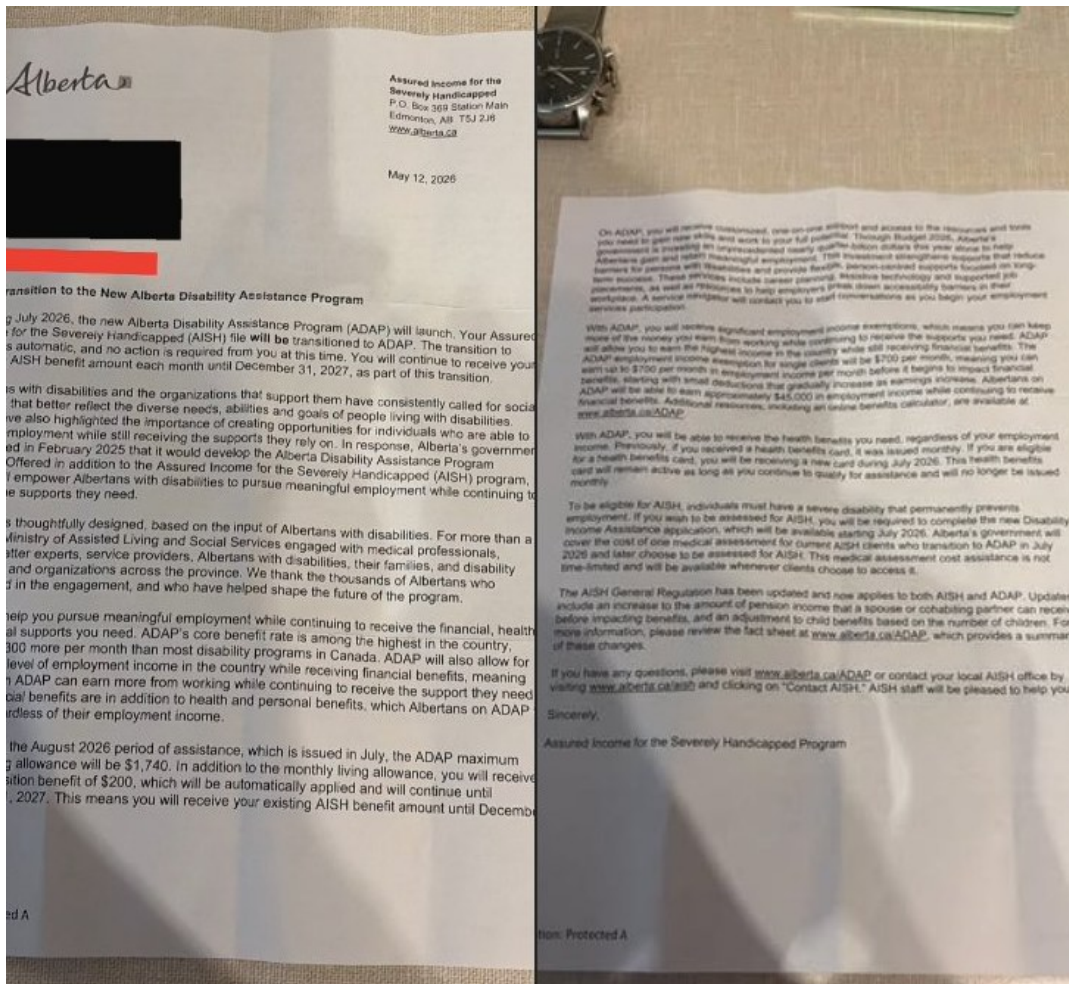
2.1 Case One: Michael Brian-Robert Wing (May 26, 2026)

Michael Brian-Robert Wing, a public member of the ADSB Facebook group, posted on May 26, 2026 (approximately 21 hours prior to the publication of this submission) a public statement reporting that he had received an ADAP placement letter despite being PDD-eligible. His full statement, in his own words:

“Well, unsurprisingly, the government lied. I’m being transitioned to ADAP even though I’m eligible for PDD. Here’s the thing, do I think I fall more in line with ADAP? Yes. However, they still lied about who would not be transitioned.”

— Michael Brian-Robert Wing, public post in the Alberta Disability System Breakdown Facebook group, May 26, 2026.

Mr. Wing also published photographic evidence of the placement letter itself, on the official May 12, 2026 letterhead of Alberta — Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped, P.O. Box 369 Station Main, Edmonton, AB, T5J 2J6. Personal-identifying information has been redacted by Mr. Wing in his original post. The letter image is reproduced below as primary-source documentation:



Primary source: Letter from Alberta — Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped, dated May 12, 2026, photographed and published by Michael Brian-Robert Wing in the public Alberta Disability System Breakdown Facebook group, May 26, 2026. Personal-identifying information redacted by the recipient.

Mr. Wing's framing is documentary and precise. He does not argue that ADAP is structurally wrong for him personally; he states the opposite. He documents that the government's **published criteria did not match the placement decision he received**. The relevant breach is not policy-fit but criteria-honouring.

2.2 Case Two: Sarah Margetts-Hébert (May 27, 2026)

On May 27, 2026, approximately 19 minutes after publishing her account, Sarah Margetts-Hébert posted publicly in the same Alberta Disability System Breakdown Facebook group:

“Apparently multiple people including my daughter are receiving letters saying she is being transitioning to ADAP despite being PDD eligible. I called the AISH office and they said yes, we have been receiving a lot of calls about this. We don’t know what’s going on. We applied for PDD and she was accepted but we decided at that time we were not going to use their services since I am at home looking after her.”

— Sarah Margetts-Hébert, public post in the Alberta Disability System Breakdown Facebook group, May 27, 2026.

Ms. Margetts-Hébert’s account establishes three things on the documented record:

- **Her daughter is PDD-eligible.** The family applied for the program. The daughter was assessed and accepted. The decision not to use PDD services (because Ms. Margetts-Hébert provides care at home) does not affect the underlying eligibility. Her daughter sits squarely inside the first of the government’s four named exempt categories.
- **She received an ADAP placement letter for her daughter.** The placement decision contradicts the published exemption category her daughter qualifies under.
- **AISH staff confirmed the pattern is widespread, and confirmed that AISH itself cannot explain it.** When Ms. Margetts-Hébert called the AISH office, the staff member told her that AISH has been receiving “a lot of calls” of this type, and that “we don’t know what’s going on.” Both statements are now on the documented public record.

WHAT THE AISH OFFICE TOLD A CALLER ON MAY 27, 2026:

“Yes, we have been receiving a lot of calls about this. We don’t know what’s going on.”

AISH frontline staff, reported by Sarah Margetts-Hébert, public post, Alberta Disability System Breakdown Facebook group, May 27, 2026. Thirty-six days before the operational launch of ADAP. With placement letters already in the mail.

2.3 Case Three: A Live-Call Denial (May 27, 2026)

On May 27, 2026, a third account moved the documented record from administrative confusion to active denial. A recipient published a public account — viewed approximately 1,700 times within its first 37 minutes — of a telephone call with an AISH staff member, written while the call was still in progress. In her own words:

"I'm currently on the phone with AISH and she is saying the circled part in this ADAP thing doesn't exist... it says right there that people with PDD stay on AISH and she says that's not true. I'm so angry she doesn't believe me so she is trying to pull up the site."

— A recipient's public account in an Alberta disability community Facebook group, May 27, 2026. The "circled part" is the PDD exemption — the first of the four exempt categories — on the Government of Alberta's own May 12, 2026 ADAP Fact Sheet, which she had on screen during the call.

This third account is the most consequential of the three. In the Wing and Margetts-Hébert cases, AISH staff acknowledged the situation — "we don't know what's going on." In this case, the AISH staff member denied that the published exemption criteria exist at all, while the recipient read those criteria aloud from the government's own public fact sheet. The documented record now contains not only placement letters that breach the published criteria, but frontline staff who deny, on a live call, that the criteria were ever published. The contradiction is no longer between two documents. It is between the Government of Alberta and itself.

2.4 What the Three Cases Together Establish

Three documented cases in approximately fifteen days — with photographic evidence of the placement letter in one, direct AISH staff confirmation in the second, and a live-call denial of the published criteria in the third — establish the following on the documented record:

- PDD-eligible recipients are receiving ADAP placement letters under date of May 12, 2026 — in breach of the government's own published exemption criteria from the same date.
- The pattern is not isolated. AISH frontline staff have confirmed on the phone that they are receiving "a lot of calls" of this type.
- AISH frontline staff are not operating from the published criteria. In one documented case, a staff member denied to a recipient — on a live call, while the recipient read the May 12 fact sheet aloud — that the PDD exemption exists at all.
- There is no published correction mechanism for recipients placed in breach of the four named exempt categories. The Citizens Appeal Panel that would previously have heard such complaints was eliminated by Bill 12 on December 9, 2025.

3. The Five-Year Arc of Quiet Removal

The three May 2026 cases above are the operational expression of a longer pattern. Since 2021, the Government of Alberta has progressively removed public visibility from the PDD program — the very program named first in the May 12, 2026 ADAP fact sheet as the foundational exemption category. The campaign's existing evidentiary record documents the arc:

2021	Last year the Government of Alberta publicly reported PDD waitlist data. Five years and counting.
2022	Alberta Auditor General Report on FSCD identifies systemic failures in the program that feeds adults into the PDD waitlist at age 18. Findings include: training program not effectively delivered, oversight processes of caseworker performance ineffective. The government received these findings four years ago.
Late 2024	Inclusion Alberta surveys 540 PDD-connected individuals because the Government will not release PDD waitlist data. The report, published January 2025, documents that 70% of respondents still need to meet with a caseworker to develop the outcome plan that determines their services, and 41% of those receiving supports report the supports aren't helping.
2024–2025	Individual caseworker assignments eliminated across most of Alberta. Calls now routed to the first available staff member. Direct worker phone numbers deactivated.
September 2024	Seven temporary FSCD caseworker contracts not renewed. PDD-feeding caseworker capacity contracts further.
Budget 2025	PDD budget increases by 5.94% — against population-plus-inflation growth of 7.3%. Real-terms gap: –1.36%. The program serving the first named ADAP exemption category is funded below the rate of need-growth in the same year the exemption category is announced.
March 2026	Three advocacy organizations serving PDD families lose funding twelve months early. First closure now confirmed in the documented record.
December 9, 2025	Bill 12 passes. The Citizens Appeal Panel — which previously overturned 37% of disability income decisions across 3,218 hearings over four fiscal years — is eliminated under section 12.8. The Medical Review Panel that replaces it does not have independent administrative-appeal jurisdiction over individual placement decisions.
May 12, 2026	ADAP Fact Sheet published. PDD named as the first of four categories for automatic AISH continuation. Placement letters begin going out the same week.

May 12–27, 2026

PDD-eligible recipients begin receiving ADAP placement letters in breach of the published criteria. AISH frontline staff confirm to callers that they are receiving “a lot of calls” of this type and that “we don’t know what’s going on” — and, in one documented live call viewed roughly 1,700 times in 37 minutes, deny that the published PDD exemption exists at all.

WHAT THE ARC SHOWS

Five years of decreasing public visibility into the PDD program, culminating in the May 12, 2026 fact sheet that names PDD as the foundational exemption category — followed in the same week by placement letters that the named exemption appears not to have honoured, and by AISH staff confirmation that the breach is widespread and that they cannot explain it. The documented record establishes that the architecture of the breach pre-dates the placement letters by years.

Sources: AISH Evidentiary Report Series 2026; Systematic Exclusion Alberta Complete Collection (April 2026); Inclusion Alberta — “PDD Current State: Critical and Urgent,” January 2025 (540 respondents); Alberta Auditor General Report on FSCD, 2022; Alberta Budget 2025; CBC News, January 23, 2025; Bill 12 — An Act to Strengthen and Protect Alberta’s Social Supports, section 12.8.

4. What the Documented Record Now Demands

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown places the following on the documented record and respectfully requests written responses from the Minister of Assisted Living and Social Services, the Office of the Premier of Alberta, and from the nine municipal coalition councils that have passed motions on the AISH-to-ADAP file (Calgary, Edmonton, St. Albert, Lethbridge, Red Deer, Medicine Hat, Camrose, Claresholm, and the City of Cold Lake), prior to the operational launch of ADAP on July 1, 2026.

4.1 Immediate publication of the placement criteria.

The operational criteria by which an individual AISH recipient's file is assessed against the four named exemption categories must be published in the Alberta Gazette and on the Ministry's public-facing site, prior to further placement letters being issued and prior to the July 1, 2026 launch.

4.2 Written ministerial explanation of how PDD-eligible recipients were placed in ADAP.

The Minister of Assisted Living and Social Services is asked to respond, in writing, to the documented record above: how were PDD-eligible recipients — in the first named exemption category of the government's own May 12, 2026 fact sheet — placed in the ADAP-transitioning stream rather than the AISH-continuing stream? What internal review of the placement decisions is being conducted, on what timeline, and with what disclosure?

4.3 Reassessment of all PDD-eligible placements before July 1, 2026.

Every recipient with documented PDD eligibility currently scheduled to transition to ADAP on July 1, 2026 must have their placement decision reassessed against the published exemption category prior to that date. The reassessment should be conducted at no cost to the recipient, require no further documentation beyond the existing PDD eligibility record, and produce a written correction notice where the original placement is found to have been in error.

4.4 Restoration of PDD waitlist data publication.

The Government of Alberta is asked to resume the public reporting of the PDD waitlist that ceased in 2021. The first named exemption category in the May 12, 2026 fact sheet cannot be operated transparently while the underlying program operates without public visibility. The documented record establishes that Inclusion Alberta has formally requested this data and has not received it.

4.5 Reinstatement of administrative-appeal jurisdiction.

Bill 12 eliminated the Citizens Appeal Panel that previously overturned 37% of disability income decisions across 3,218 hearings over four fiscal years. With placement letters now demonstrably in breach of the published criteria, recipients require an independent administrative-appeal mechanism with jurisdiction over individual placement decisions.

4.6 Written response by the May 30, 2026 deadline acknowledged in government communications.

The Government of Alberta is asked to respond, in writing, to the affected community by the May 30, 2026 written-response deadline. Items 4.1 through 4.5 of this submission are placed on the documented record for response.

ON THE DOCUMENTED RECORD AS OF MAY 27, 2026:

Thirty-six days before the operational launch of the Alberta Disability Assistance Program, PDD-eligible Albertans are receiving ADAP placement letters in breach of the government's own published exemption criteria. AISH frontline staff are receiving "a lot of calls" of this type and have told at least one caller, on the public record, that they "don't know what's going on." The criteria that would resolve the breach have not been publicly published. The PDD waitlist that would establish the affected population's size has not been publicly published since 2021. The appeal mechanism that would review individual placement decisions has been eliminated under Bill 12. The documented record between today and June 30, 2026 will reflect what each authority addressed in this submission did, and did not do, in response.

Sources

Primary source — ADAP placement letter:

Photograph published by Michael Brian-Robert Wing in the public Alberta Disability System Breakdown Facebook group, May 26, 2026. Letter dated May 12, 2026 on the letterhead of Alberta — Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped, P.O. Box 369 Station Main, Edmonton, AB T5J 2J6. Reproduced in this submission with personal-identifying information redacted by the original recipient.

Primary source — AISH staff statement:

Public account by Sarah Margetts-Hébert in the public Alberta Disability System Breakdown Facebook group, May 27, 2026, reporting the response received from AISH frontline staff during a telephone inquiry on the same date.

Primary source — live-call denial:

Public account by a recipient in an Alberta disability community Facebook group, May 27, 2026, written during a live telephone call with AISH and viewed approximately 1,700 times within 37 minutes, documenting an AISH staff member denying that the published PDD exemption exists while the recipient read the May 12, 2026 ADAP Fact Sheet aloud.

Government of Alberta:

ADAP Fact Sheet (Classification: Public), Assisted Living and Social Services, May 12, 2026. AISH General Regulation. Alberta Gazette — publication record reviewed as of the date of this submission.

Bill 12:

An Act to Strengthen and Protect Alberta's Social Supports, Royal Assent December 9, 2025. Section 12.8 (elimination of Citizens Appeal Panel). Citizens Appeal Panel statistical record: 37% overturn rate across 3,218 hearings, four fiscal years.

Inclusion Alberta:

"PDD Current State: Critical and Urgent," January 2025, surveying 540 PDD-connected individuals. Inclusion Alberta Budget 2025 media release.

Auditor General of Alberta:

Report on Family Support for Children with Disabilities (FSCD), 2022.

CBC News:

January 23, 2025 (PDD funding); October 20, 2025 (Civida affordable-housing waitlist).

Campaign evidentiary record:

AISH Evidentiary Report Series 2026 (April 2026); Systematic Exclusion Alberta Complete Collection (April 2026); The Cage Doesn't End — Disability, Aging, and Canadian Income Security (May 2026); Income Crossover Analysis, Revised May 2026.

Shadow Minister Marie Renaud:

Floor statement, Legislative Assembly of Alberta, May 14, 2026.

Coalition municipal motions:

Edmonton (January 2026); Lethbridge (February 25, 2026); Calgary (April 13, 2026); Red Deer (April 15, 2026, notice of motion by Cllr. Cassandra Curtis); St. Albert (May 19, 2026, 6-0 vote, motion from Cllr. Amanda Patrick); Camrose;

Claresholm; Medicine Hat (early May 2026); City of Cold Lake (May 28, 2026 — Lakeland Connect).

Public Attribution Notice

The two named community members cited in this submission — Michael Brian-Robert Wing and Sarah Margetts-Hébert — published their accounts publicly in the open Alberta Disability System Breakdown Facebook group. The third account, a live-call denial, is cited without attribution as a public post in a separate Alberta disability community group. Their statements and, in Mr. Wing's case, the photograph of his placement letter are cited here as primary-source documentation. Personal-identifying details visible in the original letter have been redacted by Mr. Wing himself in his original post.